Victoria Festival of Authors Code of Conduct/ Safer Spaces Policy

Victoria Festival of Authors (VFA) endeavours to provide welcoming, inclusive, and safer spaces, as much as is reasonably practical, to all of our community members, including attendees, performers, volunteers and VFA team members.

All participants, including staff, contractors, volunteers, performers and attendees at Victoria Festival of Authors events must adhere to our Code of Conduct while in festival spaces. Festival spaces include any indoor and outdoor venue used for in-person programming, all virtual events, and online communication and social media pages. As representatives of VFA, all staff, contractors and volunteers must adhere to the Code of Conduct when working in roles outside of festival events.

Code of Conduct:

Individuals at Victoria Festival of Authors will ensure a safer space by:

- Being respectful of all individuals in VFA spaces, including attendees, performers, volunteers and VFA team members
- Respecting the identities of all individuals in VFA spaces, including their age, ability, ethnicity, gender expression, gender identity, race, religion, and sexual orientation
- Respecting efforts made by VFA to create inclusive events, including all-gender washrooms and accommodations made for those with visible or invisible disabilities
- Respecting the work of our performers, which may include adult themes, topics exploring sexuality and gender and content related to trauma and mental health
- Not engaging in cultural appropriation (performers featuring work inspired by a particular culture or group without ties to that community) or art theft (including misrepresenting work or using artificial intelligence)

Violation of these policies includes disrespectful, discriminatory, bullying or harassing behaviors as prohibited by the Human Rights Code or the Occupational Health and Safety policies under the Workers Compensation Act. This extends to comments and questions during in-person performances, or posts during virtual events, as well as disrespectful behaviour before and after these events. This also includes any work done outside of festival events by representatives of VFA, including by staff, contractors and volunteers.

If you are in violation of the VFA Code of Conduct/ Safer Spaces Policy, you may be asked to modify your behaviour or leave the event.

We acknowledge that all situations are distinct and require appropriate thought to how concerns will be approached. To ensure the situation is handled appropriately without bias, not all

situations will be granted the same response. If you feel uncomfortable at one of our events or witness someone in breach of the VFA Code of Conduct, please reach out to a VFA team member as soon as possible.

VFA's Commitment:

VFA has a responsibility to advise all staff, performers and volunteers of our policies regarding the creation of safe spaces. The Code of Conduct/ Safer Spaces Policy will be posted on our website, and a link will be provided in artists packages and in the VFA program

All staff, performers, attendees and volunteers have the right to raise a concern related to VFA's Code of Conduct/ Safer Spaces Policy and have that concern addressed in a respectful and timely manner

VFA will make accommodations for attendees and performers who identify a need

All event volunteers and VFA team members will attend cultural safety and accessibility training

Reviews of policy and practices will be done annually with additional training done as relevant to ensure the Code of Conduct/Safer Spaces Policy is up-to-date and ongoing education is occurring.

If you need support or have comments about our Code of Conduct and Safer Spaces Policy please contact us at info@victoriafestivalofauthors.ca